Negative Double

Partner opens 1 of a suit and the next opponent overcalls a suit:
Double by you is not for penalty - it says you **would** have responded if no overcall.
You need 6+ points for 1-level double, more for higher level double
Negative Double promises at least four cards in any unbid Major
If both Majors have been bid, double promises both minors
1♣/♦ - 1♥ - dbl - promises 4-card Spade suit
1♣/♦ - 1♥ - 1♠ - promises 5+ card Spade suit

Support Cue-bid

When partner opens and next player overcalls, a Cue-bid by you shows Limit-raise or better support for partner's suit. Any raise of partner's suit is preemptive and shows LESS than a Limit-raise.

When an opponent opens, partner overcalls, and the next opponent passes, a Cue-bid by you shows Limit-raise or better support for partner's suit. Any raise of partner's suit is preemptive and shows LESS than a Limit-raise.

Board: 1
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠K

Board: 2
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥J

Board: 3
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 2♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♥Q

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣5

Board 1
West Deals
None Vul

♠ 8 5 2
♥ A Q 10 9 3
♦ 9 7
♣ A Q 2

♠ A J 6 4
♥ 6 2
♦ K J 4 3
♣ J 7 3



♠ K Q 10 3
♥ J 5
♦ A Q 5 2
♣ 8 6 5

♠ 9 7
♥ K 8 7 4
♦ 10 8 6
♣ K 10 9 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
Pass	1♥	1♠	3♥
All Pass			

3♥ by North
Lead: ♠K

Compare this with Deal 8.

SOUTH has 7 points, barely enough for a 2♥ raise if there had been no overcall. But when EAST puts in the ♠ bid, SOUTH can jump to 3♥ as a preemptive measure. He knows NORTH won't think he has strength because he did not make a Support Cue-bid.

NORTH does know it and passes 3♥.

Board 2
North Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ J 10 ♥ Q 8 7 5 ♦ K Q 10 8 ♣ Q 6 3	
♠ Q 8 6 2 ♥ A K 9 3 ♦ 9 7 ♣ A 8 2		♠ A K 9 7 3 ♥ 6 4 ♦ 6 3 ♣ K J 10 4
	♠ 5 4 ♥ J 10 2 ♦ A J 5 4 2 ♣ 9 7 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♦	1♠	Pass
2♦	Pass	3♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by East
Lead: ♥J

WEST has the strength for a raise to game in ♠s, but this could be dangerous since EAST has overcalled rather than opened. Instead, WEST shows her strength with a Support Cue-bid.

EAST in fact had a pretty good overcall so he jumps to 3♠ and WEST bids the game.

With a weak overcall EAST would have just returned to 2♠ which WEST would pass.

Board 3
East Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 8 6 2
♥ A K 9 3
♦ 9 7
♣ A 8 2

♠ J 10
♥ Q J 10
♦ J 8 6 4
♣ J 9 5 4



♠ 5 4
♥ 8 7 2
♦ A K 10 5 2
♣ K Q 10

♠ A K 9 7 3
♥ 6 5 4
♦ Q 3
♣ 7 6 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♦	1♠
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♠
All Pass			

2♠ by South
Lead: ♥Q

Compare this to Deal 10.

NORTH has the strength for a raise to game in ♠s, but this could be dangerous since SOUTH has overcalled rather than opened. Instead, NORTH shows her strength with a Support Cue-bid.

SOUTH has very minimal overcall so he just bids 2♠ which NORTH passes.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ K 4 3 2 ♥ 6 2 ♦ 9 7 6 ♣ 10 7 5 2	
♠ 8 ♥ A K 10 8 7 ♦ K Q J 4 ♣ A K 6		♠ Q 7 5 ♥ Q J 9 3 ♦ A 10 8 2 ♣ Q 8
	♠ A J 10 9 6 ♥ 5 4 ♦ 5 3 ♣ J 9 4 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	1♠	2♠	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♥ by West
Lead: ♣5

WEST has a maximum 1♥ opening bid.

EAST would have made a Limit Raise in ♥s, but after NORTH's overcall she makes a Support Cue-bid instead.

WEST thinks there may be a slam and bids 4NT Blackwood to check for Aces. When EAST admits to one Ace WEST bids the slam.